

Honesty used to be part of the definition of a true scholar. Anyone who wishes to be one should absolutely stop representing his presuppositions as being part of the evidence. Since the original was never lost, there is no legitimate textual criticism of the NT, and therefore no science of such. Since NT textual criticism (as practiced by the academic community during the past 130 years) depends on a false presupposition, it cannot be a science. Those who reject the primary evidence can, and probably will, continue to propound a theory of textual criticism. I suppose they have a right to their theory, but I cannot wish them well.

Aland's Presentation of the Evidence

For this discussion I will use statistics offered by Kurt Aland and his Institute for New Testament Textual Research. Since he despised the Byzantine Text and was a devoted champion of his Egyptian text, we can be absolutely certain that the evidence will not be presented so as to favor the Byzantine Text in any way.

The Uncials

In *The Text of the New Testament*¹ K. Aland offers a summary of the results of a "systematic test collation" for the more important uncials from centuries IV-IX. He uses four headings: "Byzantine", "original", "agreements" between the first two, and "independent or distinctive" readings. Since by "original" he seems to mean essentially "Egyptian" (or "Alexandrian") I will use the following headings: Egyptian, Majority ("Byzantine"), both ("agreements") and other ("independent"). I proceed to chart each MS from the IV through IX centuries for which Aland offers a summary:

By way of explanation: "cont." stands for content, **e** = Gospels (but Aland's figures cover only the Synoptics), **a** = Acts, **p** = Pauline Epistles (including Hebrews) and **c** = Catholic Epistles; "Cat." refers to Aland's five categories (*The Text*, pp. 105-6) and "class." stands for a classification devised by me wherein **E** = Egyptian, **M** = Majority and **O** = other. It has the following values, which are illustrated with M:

M+++++	=	100%			
M++++	=	over 95%	=	19:1	= very strong
M+++	=	over 90%	=	9:1	= strong
M++	=	over 80%	=	4:1	= good
M+	=	over 66%	=	2:1	= fair
M	=	over 50%	=	1:1	= weak

¹ K. and B. Aland, *Ibid.*, pp. 106-125.